“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 9

The Deliverance of Gopīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

1 By the flood of their love, the countless blessed associates of Śrī Caitanya have turned the desert of unfortunate hearts forever into a well-watered land.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the merciful! Glory, glory to Nityānanda, whose heart is full of compassion![2]

3 Glory to Advaitācārya; glory, glory to the merciful one! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura, who are full of rasa!

4 In this way Mahāprabhu lived in Nīlācala with His devotees, in the joy of love for Kṛṣṇa.

5 Within and without, waves of separation from Kṛṣṇa surged, and the Lord’s mind and body were restless with many kinds of *bhāva*.

6 By day He danced and sang kīrtana and beheld Jagannātha; by night He relished rasa with Rāya and Svarūpa.

7 People of the three worlds came to see Him, and whoever saw Him gained the treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa.

8 Devas, gandharvas and kinnaras came in human guise, and so did all the Daityas and Nāgas of the seven nether worlds.[3]

9 All who dwell on the seven island-continents (*dvīpas*) and in the nine regions (*khaṇḍas*) came in many guises to see the Lord.[4]

10 Sages such as Prahlāda, Bali, Vyāsa and Śuka came, and on seeing the Lord they lost consciousness in love.

11 Outside, the people who could not see Him cried out aloud; then the Lord would come out and say, “Say ‘Kṛṣṇa’!”

12 At the sight of the Lord all the people were swept away in love. In this way the Lord’s days and nights passed.

13 One day people came and reported to the Lord, “The Baḍa Jānā, the eldest prince, has raised Gopīnātha onto the *cāṅga*, the execution platform.[5]

14 They have set swords beneath it and will throw him down onto them from above. Only if You, Lord, protect him will he be saved.

15 Bhavānanda Rāya and his whole family are Your servants. His son is Your servant, and it is fitting that You protect him.”

16 The Lord asked, “Why is the king punishing him?” Then the people told Him the whole story.

17 “Gopīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka, Rāmānanda’s brother, has always been a keeper of the king’s property (*rāja-viṣayī*).

18 His charge was Mālajāṭhyā Daṇḍapāṭa. He collected the revenue there and delivered it to the king’s court.[6]

19 Two lakhs of kāhanas were left outstanding against him, and the king demanded the full sum — two lakhs of kāhanas of cowries.[7]

20 He said, ‘I have no large sum in hand to pay it all at once. Little by little, by selling and buying, I will make good the money.[8]

21 I have ten or twelve horses; take them at a fair valuation.’ Saying this, he led the horses to the king’s gate.

22 One prince knew the value of horses well, and the king sent him there with ministers and companions.

23 That prince set the value low, and Gopīnātha grew angry when he heard the price.

24 That prince had a habit: he would turn his neck and, with his face upward, look here and there again and again.

25 Mocking him, Gopīnātha spoke proud words; the king favoured him, so he felt no fear.

26 ‘My horse raises its neck, but it does not look upward. So it is not right to set its price low.’

27 Hearing this, the prince grew angry. He went to the king and slandered Gopīnātha at length:

28 ‘This man will not pay the money; he goes about making excuses. Give the order, and I will raise him onto the *cāṅga* and get the money.’

29 The king said, ‘Go and do whatever is best. Use any means by which I may get the money.’

30 The prince came and had him raised onto the *cāṅga*, and beneath it he set swords, to throw him down onto them.”

31 Hearing this, the Lord spoke with a show of affectionate anger: “He will not pay the king’s money; what fault is there in the king?[9]

32 He collects the king’s revenue and consumes it without any fear of the king, squandering it in various ways on harlots and dancers.

33 Let one who is clever do the king’s service: when he has paid off the king’s dues, let him spend what is left to him.”

34 Just then another man came running: “Vāṇīnātha and the others have been bound and taken away with their families!”

35 The Lord said, “The king himself will collect the money due on his accounts. I am a detached sannyāsī; what can I do in this?”[10]

36 Then Svarūpa and the other devotees of the Lord all made an entreaty at His feet:

37 “The family of Rāmānanda Rāya are all Your servants. Such indifference is not fitting for You.”

38 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu spoke angrily: “So you all order Me to go to the king’s court!

39 This is what you all think: that I should go to the king, spread out the end of My cloth and beg the money from him.

40 A sannyāsī brāhmaṇa is fit to receive at most five gaṇḍās, twenty cowries. Even if I begged, why would anyone give two lakhs of kāhanas?”[11]

41 Just then another man came running: “They are throwing Gopīnātha down onto the swords!”

42 Hearing this, the Lord’s associates entreated Him, but the Lord said, “I am a beggar; I can do nothing.[12]

43 So if you all have it in mind to save him, go together to the feet of Jagannātha.

44 Jagannātha is Īśvara, the Lord Himself, and all things are in His hands. He is able to do, not to do, or to do otherwise.”[13]

45 While Mahāprabhu was saying this, Haricandana Pātra went and spoke to the king:

46 “Gopīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka is your servant, and to put a servant to death is not proper conduct.

47 Besides, he still owes you money. What would you gain by taking his life? Only the loss of your own wealth.

48 Take the horses at their proper value; whatever remains he will pay little by little. Why take his life needlessly?”

49 The king said, “I know nothing of this. Why should I take his life? It is his money I want.

50 Go there and settle everything, so that the money comes in and his life is spared.”

51 Then Haricandana came and told the prince, and Gopīnātha was quickly brought down from the *cāṅga*.

52 “The king demands the money,” Haricandana said, and asked him how he would pay. Gopīnātha replied, “Take the horses at their proper value.

53 The rest I will pay little by little, whatever I can. If you take my life without inquiry, what can I say?”

54 Then they set a fair price on all the horses and took them. For the rest of the money they fixed a date, and they sent him home.[14]

55 Meanwhile the Lord asked that man, “What was Vāṇīnātha doing when they bound him and took him away?”

56 He said, “Vāṇīnātha was fearlessly chanting the name of Kṛṣṇa, saying ‘Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa’ without rest.

57 To keep count, he marked the names on the fingers of both hands, and each time a thousand were complete, he scratched a line on his body.”[15]

58 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu was supremely joyful. Who can fathom the mercy of Gaura, veiled beneath another guise?[16]

59 At that time Kāśī Miśra came to the Lord, and the Lord spoke to him with some anxiety:

60 “I cannot stay here; I shall go to Ālālanātha. There are many disturbances here, and I find no peace.

61 The family of Bhavānanda Rāya is in the king's service, and in various ways they spend the king's money.

62 What fault is there in the king? He wants only his own money. They will not pay it, and then they come to Me complaining of their punishment.

63 When the king had Gopīnātha raised onto the *cāṅga*, people came four times to tell Me.

64 I am a mendicant sannyāsī who lives in solitude, yet they come and pain Me by telling Me their own troubles.

65 Today Jagannātha has protected him; but tomorrow who will protect him if he does not pay the king's money?

66 Hearing the affairs of worldly men disturbs My mind, and so I have no reason to stay here."

67 Clasping the Lord's feet, Kāśī Miśra said, "Why do You let this matter trouble Your mind?

68 You are a detached sannyāsī — what connection have You with anyone? One who worships You for worldly ends is blind to true knowledge.[17]

69 The fruit of worshipping You is the treasure of love for You. One who worships You for the sake of worldly things is a fool.

70 For Your sake Rāmānanda gave up his governorship; for Your sake Sanātana abandoned his worldly position.

71 For Your sake Raghunātha gave up everything, and his father sent him wealth here.

72 But the mercy of Your feet has come to him: he begs his food at the alms-house and does not touch that wealth.

73 The noble Gopīnātha, Rāmānanda's brother, has no wish for worldly gain from You.

74 Seeing his distress, his servants and others told You of it, for he has no shelter but You (*ananya-śaraṇa*).

75 He is a pure devotee who worships You for Your own sake; in happiness and in distress he himself tastes the lot that falls to him.[18]

76 He longs for Your mercy and worships You constantly; soon he attains Your feet.

77 'Therefore one who lives earnestly awaiting Your mercy, enduring the fruits of his own deeds and offering You obeisance with heart, words and body, is an heir to the position of liberation.' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.8)[19]

78 Stay on here. Why should You go to Ālālanātha? No one will make You listen to the talk of worldly men.

79 If You have a mind to protect him, He who protected him today will protect him still."[20]

80 Saying this, Kāśī Miśra went home, and at midday Pratāparudra came to his house.[21]

81 Pratāparudra kept one rule for as long as he stayed in Śrī Puruṣottama.

82 Every day he would come and massage Miśra's feet, and hear how the service of Jagannātha was being carried out in all its order and splendour (*bhiyāna*).[22]

83 When the king began pressing his feet, Miśra spoke to him in a roundabout way:

84 "Your Majesty, hear one more strange piece of news: Mahāprabhu is going to leave the holy place (*kṣetra*) for Ālālanātha!"

85 Hearing this, the king became sorrowful and asked the reason. Then Miśra told him the whole story:

86 "Gopīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka was raised onto the *cāṅga*, and his servant came and told the Lord.

87 When Mahāprabhu heard this, His mind was agitated, and in anger He rebuked Gopīnātha severely:[23]

88 'He handles the king's affairs without controlling his senses, and spends the king's wealth in all sorts of wrong ways.

89 The king's wealth weighs more than a brāhmaṇa's property; one who steals it to enjoy it is a great sinner.

90 He lives on the king's salary and steals besides; by the judgment of scripture he deserves the king's punishment.

91 The king asks only for his own money and does not punish him. The king is most righteous; this man is a sinful cheat!

92 He does not pay the king's money, and he cries out loudly to Me (*phukāre*). Who here can bear such great distress?

93 I shall go to Ālālanātha and stay there free from care; I will not hear the news of worldly men, good or bad.’”

94 At this the king felt pain in his heart and said, “I give up all the money, if only the Lord will stay here.

95 If I can have the Lord’s darśana for even a moment, not even millions of *cintāmaṇi* gems can equal it.

96 And what are these two lakhs of kāhanas? A paltry thing! My life and my kingdom I offer at the Lord’s feet in worship (*nirmañchana*).”[24]

97 Miśra said, “It is not the Lord’s wish that you give up the money. They are suffering, and that He cannot bear.”[25]

98 The king said, “I mean him no pain. Raising him onto the *cāṅga*, throwing him onto the swords — I knew nothing of it.

99 He mocked Puruṣottama Jānā, and that Jānā only gave him a false scare.

100 Go and do all you can to keep the Lord here. Here and now I release him from all the money.”

101 Miśra said, “The Lord does not want you to give up the money. If you do, perhaps He will be pained.”

102 The king said, “I shall give up the money, but do not tell Him that. Let Him know only this: they are naturally dear to me.

103 Bhavānanda Rāya is worthy of my honour and esteem (*pūjya-garvita*), and I naturally feel affection for his sons.”

104 Saying this, the king offered obeisance to Miśra and went home. And the Baḍa Jānā summoned Gopīnātha.[26]

105 The king said, “I release you from all the money, and I give you that same Mālajāṭhyā Daṇḍapāṭa again.

106 Do not consume the king’s wealth like this again. From today I give you double salary.”

107 Saying this, he dressed him in silk cloth (*netadhaṭī*): “Take the Lord’s permission and go; you have your leave.”

108 Leave aside the Lord’s mercy in the highest, spiritual sense (*paramārtha*): its fruit is endless, and who can describe it?[27]

109 This fruit, a domain and worldly wealth, came from a mere semblance (*ābhāsa*) of His mercy, and no one can even begin to reckon it!

110 On one hand, he was raised onto the *cāṅga* to be stripped of wealth and life! On the other, everything was forgiven, and that same domain and more were bestowed on him!

111 On one hand, all he owned was to be sold off, and still the money could not be paid! On the other, a double salary, and a silk cloth to wear!

112 The Lord had no wish that his money be remitted, that his salary be doubled, or that he be given his post again.

113 Still, his servant came and made his petition, and Mahāprabhu’s mind was disturbed by it.

114 The Lord had no inclination to give worldly happiness; yet even by the power of a mere petition such fruit was borne.

115 Who can describe the wonderful nature of Gaura? Even Brahmā, Śiva and the others cannot fathom His inner intent.

116 Meanwhile Kāśī Miśra came to the Lord's feet and reported all that the king had done.

117 The Lord said, "Kāśī Miśra, what have you done? Have you made Me accept a gift from the king (*rāja-pratigraha*)?"[28]

118 Miśra said, "Lord, hear the king's words. Without any guile the king made this request:

119 'Let the Lord not think that the king has given up two lakhs of kāhanas for His sake.

120 All of Bhavānanda's sons are most dear to me; I regard them all as my own self.

121 So I give them posts here and there. They eat, drink, plunder and give away, and I do not look into it.

122 In Rājamahendrī I made Rāmānanda Rāya governor (*rājā*). Whatever he consumed and whatever he gave away, no account was asked of him.[29]

123 In the same way, while handling the king's business, Gopīnātha goes on consuming two to four lakhs of kāhanas.

124 Some of it he pays and some he does not, and I do not look into it. This time he came to grief through his ill will with the Jānā.

125 I did not know that the Jānā had gone so far. I regard all of Bhavānanda's sons as my own self.

126 Let Him not consider that I am giving up the money for His sake (*māt*, “not”): my love for them is natural.’”[30]

127 Hearing of the king’s humility, the Lord was pleased. Just then Bhavānanda Rāya arrived there.

128 He came with his five sons and fell at the Lord’s feet. The Lord raised him up and embraced him.

129 Rāmānanda Rāya and all the others met the Lord. Then Bhavānanda Rāya began to speak:

130 “My whole family are Your servants. Saving us in this danger, Lord, You have bought us again for a price (*nilā mūla*).[31]

131 Now You have shown Your affection for Your devotees, as long ago You delivered the five Pāṇḍavas from danger.”[32]

132 Gopīnātha, the silk cloth on his head, fell at the Lord’s feet and told the whole story of the king’s kindness:

133 “He remitted the money I owed and doubled my salary; he gave me my post again and dressed me in silk.

134 On one hand, that peril of death on top of the *cāṅga*! On the other, silk cloth again — all this is Your grace!

135 On the *cāṅga* I meditated on Your feet, and by the power of remembering Your feet I obtained this fruit.

136 Seeing all this happen to me, people are amazed; they sing and praise the glory of Your mercy.

137 But this is not the chief fruit of remembering You. It is only a semblance of fruit (*phalābhāsa*), for worldly things are fickle.[33]

138 You made Rāmānanda Rāya and Vāṇīnātha free from worldly affairs. But I have not received the mercy that brings this about!

139 Show me pure mercy, Gosāñi: take away my worldly affairs. I have grown weary of them (*nirviṇṇa*); worldly affairs are not for me."[34]

140 The Lord said, "If all five of you become sannyāsīs, who will maintain your large household?

141 Whether you manage great worldly affairs or live detached and indifferent to the world, birth after birth you five are My own servants.[35]

142 But keep one order of Mine: do not spend any of the king's principal (*mūla-dhana*).[36]

143 After paying the king his principal, spend whatever profit remains on various pious works.

144 Do not spend on sinful things, by which both worlds are lost." Saying this, He gave them all leave to go.[37]

145 I have told of the Lord's *kṛpā-vivarta* — a seeming mercy — shown in the house of Bhavānanda Rāya. In it His affection for His devotees was revealed.[38]

146 When He embraced them all and gave them leave, all the devotees rose and went away, calling out the name of Hari.

147 Seeing the Lord's mercy, everyone was amazed; they could not understand the Lord's conduct.

148 When they had all entreated Him to show mercy, the Lord had said, "I can do nothing."[39]

149 He only censured Gopīnātha and spoke of His own detachment (*nirveda*); no one will understand the secret of this.

150 He did not entreat Kāśī Miśra, nor did He entreat the king; yet without any effort He gave all this fruit.

151 This conduct of Śrī Caitanya is supremely deep. Only he understands it whose mind is steady (*dhīra*) at His feet.[40]

152 Whoever hears this display of the Lord's affection attains loving devotion, and his dangers are destroyed.

153 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. Heading in the edition: by the mercy of Gaura's devotees even lowly worldly people (*viṣayīs*) attain love for Kṛṣṇa. *Anubhāṣya*: the unfortunate are low people devoid of bhakti; their hearts are a waterless desert, and the flood of prema is a river overflowing its banks. ↩
2. The first line is the same as Madhya 1.188; translated as there. ↩
3. *Anubhāṣya*: *viṣadhara* — the world of the Nāgas (Nāgaloka). ↩
4. *Anubhāṣya*: see Antya 2.10 (the seven dvīpas and the nine khaṇḍas of Bhārata-varṣa). ↩
5. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Baḍa Jānā is the eldest son of the mahārāja of Orissa, the *yuvarāja* (heir to the throne); the cāṅga is a platform used for a

particular kind of execution: naked swords were set beneath it, and the condemned man was thrown down onto them. Heading in the edition: the Lord is told that Pratāparudra's son means to put Gopīnātha, the son of Bhavānanda, to death. ↩

6. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Mālajāṭhyā-daṇḍapāṭa is the district where Gopīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka was *tahsildār* (revenue collector). ↩
7. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: of the money he had paid to the king, two lakhs of kāhanas of cowries were missing; a kāhana is 1,280 cowries. ↩
8. *Anubhāṣya*: *sthūla-dravya* — valuable property or a large sum of money, with which a debt can be paid off at once. ↩
9. Heading in the edition: the Lord shows His detachment (*nirapekṣatā*) and rebukes Gopīnātha. *Anubhāṣya*: *dite nāre* — "he is unwilling to give". ↩
10. Heading in the edition: setting the example of a sannyāsī's dharma, the Lord shows indifference, or detachment, towards talk of worldly affairs. ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya*: a sannyāsī brāhmaṇa is one who has no money, has given up worldly things and lives on alms. Heading in the edition: it is not fitting for a sannyāsī to meddle in worldly affairs. ↩
12. Heading in the edition: the devotees pray to the Lord to save Gopīnātha, but to teach the people the Lord remains unbendingly detached. ↩
13. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: He alone has the power to do a thing, not to do it, or to do it otherwise. The word '*artha*' is set off in the text: it means both "every matter" and "wealth". ↩
14. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *muddatī kari'* — making him pledge to pay the money by an appointed date. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: this shows that every sādhaka who has taken full shelter of the holy name should chant the mahā-mantra "Hare Kṛṣṇa", firmly keeping a vow of number, in all circumstances — in happiness and in distress, in plenty and in hardship. ↩
16. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads কৃপা-ছদ্মবন্ধ (another reading is ছন্দবন্ধ): *kṛpā-chadma* — mercy hidden under the guise of something else: outwardly the Lord refused to intervene, yet His mercy was at work. *Anubhāṣya*: *kṛpā-chadma-bandha* — a turn of events arranged from above under the guise of grace. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* (summary of the chapter): the Lord saved and raised Gopīnātha, showing him mercy in the guise of something else. ↩
17. *Anubhāṣya*: *vyavahāra* — livelihood or worldly enjoyment; one who seeks help from Viṣṇu or the Vaiṣṇavas for his own worldly ends lacks the eyes of knowledge. Heading in the edition (to 68–69): to ask Viṣṇu for fruits to gratify one's own senses, and not to please Viṣṇu, is folly and mere trade. ↩

18. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads ভোগ-ভাগী, “one who takes his share” (another reading is ভোগ-ভোগী, “an enjoyer”): the second line speaks of the same pure devotee, who in happiness and distress himself accepts the fruit of his own deeds without asking the Lord to free him (cf. verse 77, *bhuñjāna evātma-kṛtaṁ vipākam*). Heading in the edition: the definition of a pure devotee. ↩
19. The same verse is Madhya 6.261, where Sārvabhauma recites it with *bhakti-pade*, “to the position of devotion”; here it is read *mukti-pade*, as in the *Bhāgavatam*. ↩
20. Heading in the edition: by the Lord’s mercy alone Gopīnātha will be protected in future too. ↩
21. *Sva-mandire* — “to his own dwelling”. Heading in the edition: Pratāparudra comes to the house of his guru, Miśra. ↩
22. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *bhiyāna* is the orderly and dignified performance of the service. ↩
23. Heading in the edition: the Lord, the embodiment and guardian of dharma, sternly rebukes Gopīnātha, who had taken the king’s money; there follows a description of worldly, civic and household rules — the rules of honestly earned wealth (*śukla-vitta*). ↩
24. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *nirmañchana* is a special offering — the *arghya* offered during ārati or worship. ↩
25. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads তাহা; another reading is তারা, “they”. The sense is the same: it is Gopīnātha’s family who suffer. Heading in the edition: the Lord suffers when His devotee suffers. ↩
26. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads বড় জানা (another reading is বড় জানায়, “he called the Baḍa Jānā”): the Baḍa Jānā himself summons Gopīnātha. Heading in the edition: the heir to the throne shows Gopīnātha favour and lets him go. ↩
27. Heading in the edition: the account of Gopīnātha’s punishment leads to a description of the elevation, both worldly and spiritual — the highest good (*śreyas*) — that the Lord’s mercy brings. ↩
28. *Anubhāṣya*: at Kāśī Miśra’s word the king gave up, for the Lord’s sake, the money Gopīnātha owed him; so, in the Lord’s view, it came about that He had accepted a gift from the king’s wealth (*rājārtha-pratigraha*). ↩
29. Heading in the edition: earlier, by Pratāparudra’s favour, Rāmānanda Rāya had been made governor (*bhūmi-adhikārī*) of Rājamahendrī. *Anubhāṣya*: the capital of that region in Rāmānanda Rāya’s time, Vidyānagara, lay on the southern bank of the Godāvarī, near its mouth; the present town of Rājamahendrī stands on the northern bank. ↩
30. *Māt* (a Hindi word) — “not” (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*; cf. verse 119). ↩

31. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *nilā mūla* — “You have bought us again, paying the price”. Heading in the edition: Bhavānanda says that he and all his line have sold themselves to the Lord’s feet. ↩
32. Heading in the edition: the Lord’s love for His devotees, described by a comparison — so He delivered the five Pāṇḍavas from danger. ↩
33. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the chief fruit of remembering Your lotus feet is love for You; the saving of life, honour and wealth is only a semblance of the fruit of that good deed, the service of Your feet. Worldly things are fickle in themselves, so the fruit connected with them is not the chief one. ↩
34. Heading in the edition: seeing his worldly fortune grow and fearing to lose the good fortune of serving the Lord, Gopīnātha begs at the Lord’s feet for unfeigned mercy (*amāyā-kṛpā*) and to be freed from the urge to enjoy the world. ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: if the soul knows itself as Bhagavān’s eternal servant, neither outward sannyāsa nor the outward management of great worldly affairs can harm it; devoted to Kṛṣṇa’s service, it lives in great renunciation even at home. ↩
36. Heading in the edition: Gopīnātha must do his duty to the king and spend only what is honestly earned (*śukla-artha*). ↩
37. *Anubhāṣya*: when the soul falls into sin, it becomes hard for it to gain either worldly welfare or transcendental realisation. ↩
38. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *kṛpā-vivarta* is mercy in the form of worldly welfare, which is not true mercy, though to the worldly mind it seemed to be mercy — one thing taken for another (*vivarta*). *Anubhāṣya*: in it the Lord is shown to be conquered by His devotees. Not to be confused with *kṛpā-chadma* (verse 58), mercy veiled beneath another guise. ↩
39. Heading in the edition: the hidden meaning of the Lord’s conduct in delivering Gopīnātha — at first He refuses to save him; after saving him He rebukes him for dishonest money; as an example for the renounced Vaiṣṇava He seeks solitude; Gopīnātha’s worldly fortune grows; and the Lord teaches him that one may serve Kṛṣṇa at home or away from it. *Anubhāṣya*: were Śrī Gaurasundara, in the dress of a renunciant, to help a worldly man, people would imitate Him and degrade the ideal of the renounced Vaiṣṇava; so a renunciant devotee must never take up the affairs of worldly people. ↩
40. Heading in the edition: only one whom Caitanya has drawn to Himself, and who is not shaken by the onrush of desire and enjoyment, can grasp the inner meaning of Caitanya’s deeds. ↩